

# Shipflow.se

## Complete Redesign & Production Launch

### Overview

|          |                              |
|----------|------------------------------|
| Timeline | March – May 2026             |
| Role     | Solo Developer & UI Designer |
| Status   | Live in production           |
| Client   | Flowtech International AB    |

### Context

Flowtech International AB operates a global platform used by leading shipyards, design offices, and universities across Asia, North & South America, and Europe. They needed to modernize their public-facing website for better user experience and clearer information architecture.

### User Research (2 weeks)

I conducted interviews with two key users: the directing manager and an engineer who actively uses the software. The goal was to identify what information was missing, what should be included, and what should be removed from the new design.

### Design Process (3 weeks total)

#### Week 1-2: Initial Design

Started with visual direction: colors, typography, layout. Created initial designs to show stakeholders the visual direction.

#### Week 3: Refinement & Iteration

Gathered feedback from the directing manager and engineer. Refined designs based on their input. Finalized all page views with consensus on layout, content hierarchy, and visual design.

### Implementation (6+ weeks)

#### Stage 1: Technology Decision

Evaluated options for the best platform. Decided on WordPress. Investigated hosting providers and recommended HostUp.

#### Stage 2: WordPress Build

With design finalized, focused on development. The only outstanding task was gathering real content from

Flowtech. Built custom post types, integrated plugins, configured hosting, and deployed to production.

## Technology Stack

|                        |                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CMS</b>             | WordPress (Twenty Twenty-Five FSE theme)                                                                     |
| <b>Plugins</b>         | Contact Form 7, Profile Builder, Fluent Support, ACF, WP Mail SMTP (Brevo), Newsletter, Yoast SEO, JetBackup |
| <b>Custom Features</b> | User dashboard, Documents library, Video tutorials, Publications directory, Support portal                   |
| <b>Infrastructure</b>  | HostUp hosting, Brevo email, MySQL database, SSL certificate, daily backups                                  |

## Features Delivered

| Feature            | Implementation                                                                                                   |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Custom Post Types  | News/Posts with category badges, Documents with filtering, Video tutorials with metadata, Publications directory |
| User Management    | Role-based access control, user profile pages showing account info and license details                           |
| Support Portal     | Integrated Fluent Support for customer support tickets and issue tracking                                        |
| Email Integration  | Newsletter signup via Brevo, transactional email for contact forms and support tickets                           |
| Content Management | File storage system for documents and videos, SEO optimization via Yoast                                         |

## Testing & Launch

The internship timeline was limited, which constrained formal testing phases. However, the site was thoroughly reviewed by both myself and the directing manager before launch. All core functionality was verified: form submissions, user login, document downloads, video playback, and email delivery. The site went live and has been serving Flowtech's global customer base in production.

## Handover & Documentation

Created comprehensive handover documentation covering: site overview, hosting setup, WordPress admin access, plugin usage, how to publish news, add documents, manage videos, configure email, manage support tickets, newsletter management, SEO optimization, backups, and DNS configuration.

## Key Learnings

- User interviews drive design decisions.
- Stakeholder buy-in during design prevents misalignments during build.
- WordPress with ACF provides flexibility for custom content management.
- Clear handover documentation makes projects maintainable long-term.
- Limited time forces prioritization of what matters most.

## What This Project Proved

End-to-end project ownership from user research through design, implementation, and deployment. Technology decision-making (WordPress selection and evaluation). WordPress expertise including custom post types, plugin integration, and infrastructure setup. Professional handover documentation.

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**Live Site:** <https://shipflow.se/>